MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 10/15/25

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Unapproved minutes
September 17, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of August 20, 2025, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Linda Barkel introduced herself as one of the candidates for the Republican Board of Canvasser, which the Board of Commissioners will be voting on. She informed the Commissioners that she is available to answer any questions.

A member of the public asked the Board of Commissioners what the difference in price is between the estimate and the contract for the Airport Lighting Project. Commissioner Ambrozaitis responded that the original was an estimate for the grant approval and the subsequent number was the actual bid for the grant award.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

None

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps informed the Commissioners that the State budget is still not approved. She and Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger have reviewed all State funded allocations and have notified department heads of potential impacts should the budget remain unsigned and a government shutdown occurs.

Additionally, Administrator Phelps announced that the County was awarded a Materials Management Grant from Michigan's Department of Environment, Great Lakes and Energy (EGLE) in the amount of $80,000.00 for Fiscal Year 2026. The $80,000 a year funding is expected for the next three years. Half of the Airport Grant funding has been received totaling $113,000 and the crack seal project has been completed.

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT - continued

Finally she reminded the Commissioners that they have a regular meeting scheduled for September 30, 2025 at 9 a.m.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Eric Karbowski, District 6 Director Michigan State University (MSU) Extension
   Director Karbowski gave a brief overview of the 2024 annual report. He highlighted the 4H program, Exploration Days and home ownership education classes, just to name a few of the two hundred plus programs available to area residents.

2. Bryan Krogman and Sara Miceli-Sorenson, Community Mental Health
   Bryan Krogman, the Executive Director and Sara Miceli-Sorenson, the Chief Clinical Officer from Community Mental Health presented the Board of Commissioners with the annual report of activities. They also highlighted several community partners and programs that are positively impacting Clare County residents.

JUSTICE

1. Personnel
   a. It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Gross to allow the replacement of the Public Guardian due to a retirement, **Motion carried.**

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to allow the hiring of a part-time nurse in the Clare County jail, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (0)
      Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. Senior Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the grant from Region VII Area Agency on Aging in the amount of $272,585.00 for FY 26, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Agreement for Extension Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the continued Agreement for Extension Services with MSU Extension in the amount of $158,930.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Gross, Gilmore, Haskell, Majewski and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Airport Lighting Project
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the contract between J. Ranck Electric Inc. and Clare County in the amount of $207,375.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of August 18, 2025 in the amount of $127,499.07 and the meeting minutes of September 2, 2025 in the amount of $36,160.29, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Housler, Haskell, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Hoefling, Kleinhardt and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the expenditures for the month of August 2025 in the amount of $2,912,591.29 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $36,160.29, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Housler, Gross, Hoefling and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Foreclosing Governmental Report
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve and accept the annual Foreclosing Governmental Unit Report of Real Property Foreclosure Sales, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Fancon, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Gross, Gilmore, Haskell and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

Deputy Clerk/Register of Deeds Walter read a statement from County Clerk/Register of Deeds Lori Mott highlighting the security protections Fidlar Technologies has in place and the lower price that Clerk/Register Mott negotiated on behalf of Clare County.

4. Clerk/Register of Deeds
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Fidlar Technologies 5-Year Land Records Life Cycle Extension and allow the Clerk/Register of Deeds to sign, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Haskell, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

5. Board of Canvassers
   Deputy Clerk/Register of Deeds Walter read a statement from County Clerk/Register of Deeds Lori Mott highlighting the questions asked of all nominees and their answers. Clerk/Register Mott recommended Tara Emmendorfer as the Democrat Canvasser because she was the only of the three nominees that could commit to the time needed to be a Canvasser. Clerk/Register Mott recommended Linda Barkell as the Republican Canvasser because of her extensive knowledge and experience with elections.

   a. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to appoint Tara Emmendorfer as the Democrat Board of Canvasser for the term of November 1, 2025 through October 31, 2029, **Motion carried.**

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to appoint Dina Geer as the Republican Board of Canvasser for the term of November 1, 2025 through October 31, 2029, **Motion carried.**

6. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve budget adjustments 25-206 in the amount of $226,987.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Majewski, Gilmore, Housler, Kleinhardt, Gross, Haskell and Fancon
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

No report

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the current statutory reports to the Commissioners. She is working on fiscal year end with Administrator Phelps. She reminded the Commissioners that she needs copies of all grants, contracts, and leases that were signed in FY 2025 for accounting purposes. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger mentioned that they had their land sale on August 22, 2025 and the re-offer sale will be online only on Friday, September 26, 2025 from 10 a.m. until 7 p.m. Finally, she encouraged the Commissioners to reach out to their representatives regarding house bill concerning effective postmark dates for property taxes.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore attended his meetings and had no report.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon announced that he recently visited the new Career & Technical Education (CTE) site and applauded the great program. He had no other report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis had no report.

Commissioner Housler reported that in Redding Township three board members resigned last month so only two members remain.

Commissioner Kleinhardt had no report.

Commissioner Haskell had no report.

Commissioner Gross had no report.

Commissioner Majewski attended his meetings. He gave a shout out to Dewayne Rogers and the Clare County Road Commission for clearing up issues with trees that his citizens have been concerned with.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

None

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

CLOSED SESSION

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to go into closed session to discuss the negotiation of a collective bargaining agreement (MCL 15.268 (c)), roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Majewski, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Housler, Haskell, Fancon and Gross
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

Entered into closed session at 9:53 a.m.
Back in open session at 10:07 a.m.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:09 a.m.

Isha Walter, Deputy Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners